

3.1.1 Media Player Classic

Platforms: All Windows versions.

Home Page: <http://sourceforge.net/projects/guliverkli/>

Media Player Classic (MPC) is a no-nonsense media player that reminds us of the Media Player bundled with Windows 98. Albeit, this one is open source and loaded to the hilt.

MPEG: Motion Picture Expert Group. Default compression format for VCD.
Resolution : 352 X 288 (PAL), 352 X 240 (NTSC).

MPEG2: Motion Picture Expert Group 2. Default compression format for Video DVD. Allows significantly more features than MPEG1 in the form of menus, customisable angles, customisable audio output, customisable subtitles and languages.

PAL: Phase Alteration Line, a format of Video display used in India. This is made up of 600 lines refreshed at 25fps.

NTSC: National Television Standards Committee, a format of video display mostly used in US. This is made up of 525 lines refreshed at 29.97 fps. Since most DVD players available at present can play PAL and NTSC DVDs the distinction between these formats is not significant.

VOB: Files used to store data on DVD movies.VOB files use MPEG2 compression.

DAT: Video CDs use DAT files store data. These are normal MPEG 1 files with additional information.

INTERLACED VS PROGRESSIVE: These relate to how information is displayed on a screen. Progressive display shows the entire screen in one go. Interlaced display causes data to be divided into two fields—odd and even, each one consisting of the alternate lines on the display. So a PAL screen with 576 lines is made up of 288 lines of each field. Rather than display all 576 lines of a PAL display, Interlacing causes 288 lines to be shown in one go. Since these lines are closely packed and the display is refreshed at 25 fps, the difference is barely noticeable. But it usually shows up as jagged edges when fast movement is displayed.